

Applied AI Engineer – Ascendion 10x program

Location	Bangalore, India
Experience	Final-year students and recent graduates
Discipline	Computer Science, Artificial Intelligence, Data Science, Mathematics, Electronics, Electrical Engineering, Information Science, or related fields
Application	Resume + GitHub + portfolio / project links

About Ascendion

Ascendion is a digital engineering company building modern software, data, cloud, and AI solutions for global enterprises. We work on high-impact engineering problems across product engineering, data platforms, AI-enabled applications, and enterprise transformation.

About the 10x Ascender Program

This is a selective early-career program for exceptional engineering graduates who show unusual technical depth, learning velocity, and builder instinct in Applied AI.

We are not looking for candidates who are strong only at classroom theory or standard coding interviews. We are looking for people who can understand ambiguous problems, think clearly, build practical AI systems with rigor, and use modern tools intelligently.

This program is designed for top graduates who want steep growth, real engineering exposure, and a higher bar than a conventional entry-level software role.

What you will work on

As a Graduate Applied AI Engineer, you will work on real engineering problems across AI, software, and data. Depending on the team and business problem, your work may include LLM-based applications, prompt workflows, retrieval systems, evaluation pipelines, internal AI tools, backend services, data pipelines, and AI-enabled product features.

You will be expected to move beyond experimentation and think in terms of usable systems. That means understanding the problem properly, choosing practical approaches, writing solid code, evaluating outputs, and improving quality through iteration.

You will work with modern development and AI engineering tools and will be expected to use them responsibly and effectively.

What we are looking for

- Strong fundamentals and a visible record of building meaningful technical projects beyond coursework.
- Strong programming ability and solid computer science fundamentals.
- Understanding of the basics of machine learning and modern Generative AI systems.

- Familiarity with prompting, RAG concepts, and emerging agentic engineering patterns.
- Evidence of serious technical projects, internships, research, open-source work, or hackathon builds.
- Curiosity and initiative beyond assigned work.
- Practical use of AI or developer tools with sound judgment and clear communication about technical decisions, limitations, and trade-offs.

Minimum qualifications

- Bachelor's or Master's degree from a Tier-1 engineering institute in India such as IIT or a comparable institution, in Computer Science or a closely related field.
- Strong coding skills in at least one language such as Python, Java, C++, or JavaScript/TypeScript.
- Good understanding of data structures, algorithms, databases, software engineering basics, and backend development fundamentals.
- Basic understanding of machine learning concepts such as supervised learning, model evaluation, embeddings, and inference workflows.
- Basic understanding of Generative AI concepts including prompting, retrieval-augmented generation, and AI-agent workflows.
- Evidence of at least one meaningful Applied AI, software, or data project, internship, research effort, or open-source contribution that you can explain in depth.

Preferred qualifications

- Hands-on project work in one or more of the following: LLM applications, RAG pipelines, AI copilots or chat systems, ML model development, backend engineering for AI applications, developer tooling, data systems, or evaluation workflows.
- Experience using AI coding assistants or modern AI engineering tools in a thoughtful and productive way.
- Exposure to vector databases, embeddings, API integration, workflow orchestration, or prompt evaluation.
- Participation in competitive hackathons, research labs, startup internships, or open-source communities.
- Strong evidence of self-driven building and fast learning.

What makes someone stand out

- You build things because you are curious, not because you were told to.
- You can explain what you built, why you built it, what trade-offs you made, and what you would improve.
- You understand that a working demo is not the same as a reliable AI system.
- You are comfortable with ambiguity and can bring structure to an undefined problem.
- You use AI as a force multiplier, not a substitute for thinking.

Why this role

This is not a standard graduate intake role. It is meant for candidates who want a more demanding environment, faster growth, and real technical responsibility early in their career.

If you are the kind of engineer who likes solving hard problems, building useful AI systems, and learning faster than the environment around you, this role is for you.